NICONET™

NICHOLSON STAFF INTRANET · STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

SOP · N3-M · MAINTENANCE

Maintenance workflow

How your jobs reach you, and how every repair is closed

Every repair now arrives in NicoNet with its report, photos and an agreed appointment, and every repair is closed the same way: clock on, before photo, clock off, after photo and a four-part job report. The app will not let a job close until every step is done.

WHO IT IS FOR

Every engineer, multi-trader and operative attending a repair in a resident's home, and the managers who allocate and sign off their work.

WHERE TO FIND IT

NicoNet › SOP, under the instructional film. Read it in full before your first job, then keep it to hand.

DOWNLOAD NICONET™

Scan with your phone camera to download NicoNet from the App Store or Google Play (published by Nicholson Lettings Limited). Sign in with your work email and the six-digit code we email you.

living.nicholsongroup.co.uk/get/niconet

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THE ONE RULE

If it is not done in NicoNet, it did not happen. A job you have not started, photographed, stopped, reported and completed in the app is not complete, and you are not credited with it.

PURPOSE

1 Why we work this way

Residents judge us on repairs more than on anything else. Our reviews have been held back by slow and poorly evidenced maintenance. This workflow puts that right, and it protects you.

You get the credit

Every job you close is counted against your name: time on site, right first time, the resident's rating. It feeds the Team league and your appraisal. Good work is seen.

The resident sees the work

The resident is told when you arrive and, when you finish, sees what you found, what you did, that it was tested and your before and after photos. They know exactly what was done.

Evidence if there is a dispute

If a resident disputes a repair, complains to the council or brings a disrepair claim, our record shows the time you arrived and left, what you found, what you did, the materials, the test and the photos.

We learn what repairs really take

Clock times and materials tell us how long each type of repair takes and what it costs, so jobs are planned properly and nobody is set up to fail.

THE STANDARD

Our repair timescales

PRIORITY	TARGET	EXAMPLE	ALARM TO MANAGEMENT
Emergency	2 days (made safe the same day)	Danger to health or safety, serious damage, no heating or hot water	3 days
Reactive	14 days	Something that stops part of the home working: faulty appliance, leaking tap	21 days
Inconvenience	28 days	Minor defects: sticking drawer, loose trim	42 days

Past its target a job shows red in your My jobs. At the alarm point it is escalated by email to Kevin, Callum and Paul. Team target: at least five reactive jobs completed every working day.

RECEIVING WORK

2 How your work reaches you

An alert on your phone

When Kevin or the office allocates a repair to you in NicoMGT, NicoNet sends you a push and the bell shows it. Open **Today › My jobs**. Do not start work that is not on My jobs.

How My jobs is ordered

Behind (past target) first, then **Today**, **Next 7 days**, **Later** and **No date set**. **Completed this week** sits at the bottom. Filter by Maintenance to see repairs only. Your My day screen shows today's count.

The job card

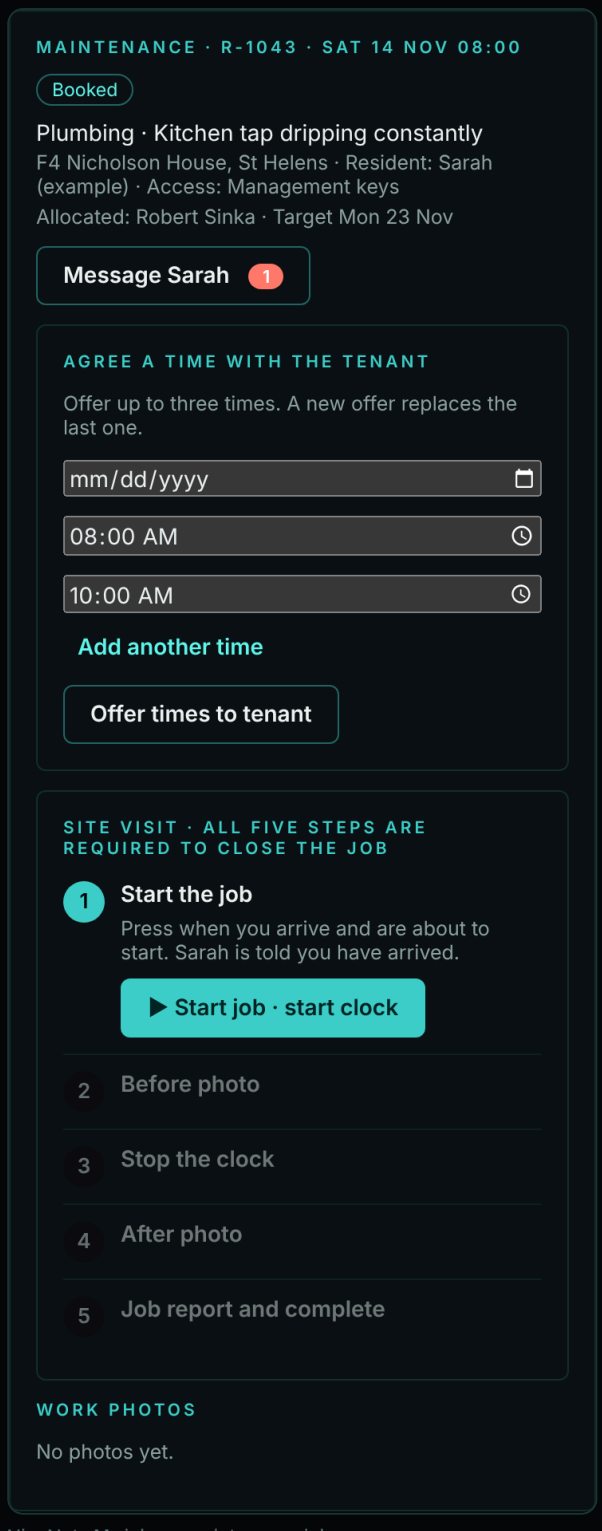
Reference (R-1042), category and description, the address, the resident's first name, access (**Management keys** or **Tenant home**) with any access notes, target date, priority (Emergency in red), the agreed appointment, the tenant's photos and video, and the Site visit box.

What you do not see

The resident's surname and phone number are never shown to you. You message them on the job instead (section 4). The office sees the full details.

Keys and lone working

Need management keys? Sign them out in **Work › Keys & tools** first and sign them back the same day. Working alone in an empty home? Check in under **Today › Lone working** with your expected finish time.



NicoNet › My jobs: a maintenance job

APPOINTMENTS

3 Agreeing the appointment

Every visit is agreed in the app, so the time is on the tenant's record, in the Maintenance calendar and in the appointment logs. Never agree a time by phone or text.

1. **The tenant suggests times**

   When the tenant reports the repair, or later from the repair, they can suggest days and times that suit them. They appear on your job card under **Agree a time with the tenant**.

2. **Agree one**

   Press **Agree** on a time you can make. It books the shared Maintenance calendar, confirms it to the tenant in Nicholson Living, adds it to both appointment logs and closes their other suggestions. No reply is needed.

3. **Or offer up to three times**

   If none suit, choose a date and window and **Add another time** – up to three – then **Offer times to tenant**. A new offer replaces the last. The tenant accepts one in the app.

4. **Reminders**

   At 07:00 every day with appointments you get your visits for the day in NicoNet. The tenant gets a reminder the day before: be home, or we will use our keys.

5. **Attended, missed or cancelled**

   Starting the job marks the appointment **attended** automatically. No access? Record **No access (missed)** – it counts as a missed appointment on the repair and the tenant is asked to choose a new time. Post a "Sorry we missed you" card. If we must cancel, record it with a reason the tenant sees.

BOOK WITHIN THE TARGET

Agree or offer times the same working day the tenant suggests them, and always inside the priority target date.

Emergencies

Make safe the same day. If a resident reports gas, fire, flood or electrical danger, they are told to call 0800 111 999 or 999; the office logs an Emergency repair and calls the emergency engineer.

RESIDENTS

4 Messaging the resident

From the moment you are allocated, the resident can message you on the repair and you can message them. It replaces calls and texts and keeps every word on record.

Open the conversation

A job with a resident message shows **Message [first name]** with an unread count. It turns red when your reply is overdue.

Reply the same working day

By 17:00 the same working day; by 17:00 the next working day if they wrote after 17:00 or at a weekend. Unanswered: Kevin is emailed (Paul if the job is Kevin's). Reply times count at appraisal.

Check & send

Every reply is checked by Claude before it reaches the resident. The first press of **Check & send** tidies it and removes any phone number, email or surname; read it, then press **Send**.

Keep it to the job

"On my way, there in 20 minutes." "Please clear the cupboard under the sink." "Part ordered, back Thursday." Anything else: point them to Messages in their app, which goes to the office.

NEVER

Give out your number, ask for theirs, use WhatsApp or social media, discuss rent, other residents or company business, or take any payment.

When the job is completed

The conversation closes and becomes read-only. It stays on the job's history. The office can read every message and can step in as "Nicholson office".

ON SITE

5 The site visit, step by step

Every maintenance job has a **Site visit** box with five steps. Each opens when the one before it is done. You cannot skip one, and nobody – not even the office – can close the job without them.

1 **Start job – clock on**

At the property, about to start, press ▶ **Start job · start clock**. The clock runs on our server, not your phone. Your position is recorded once, the appointment is marked attended and the resident is told you have arrived. Start only when you are there.

2 **Before photo**

Press **Take before photo**; the camera opens. Photograph the fault before you touch anything – wide shot, then close-up. As many as you need. Before photos can only be taken while the clock runs.

3 **Do the repair**

To N3 Maintenance: shoe covers on, protect the area, fix it first time, leave it as you found it.

4 **Stop the clock**

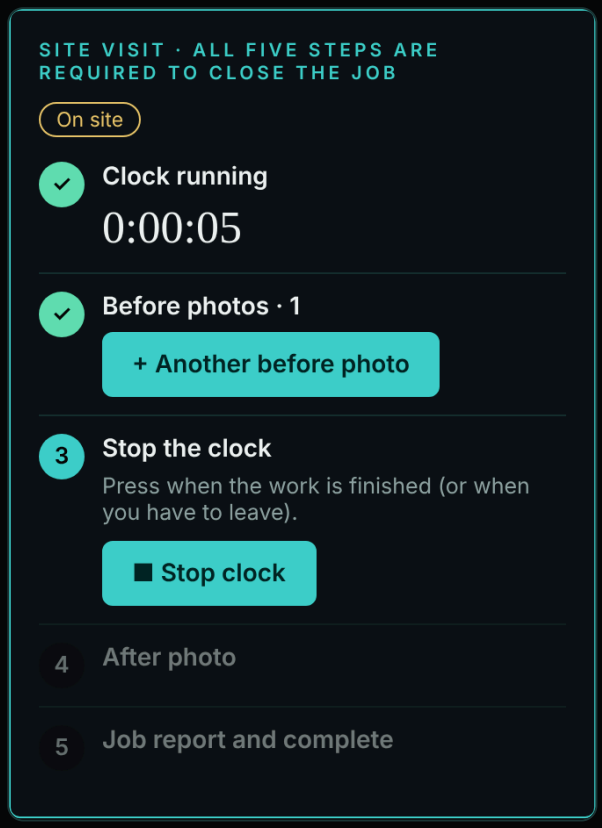
Press ■ **Stop clock** when the work is finished. It will not stop without a before photo.

5 **After photo**

Same angle as the before. After photos can only be taken once the clock has stopped. Photos cannot be changed or deleted once saved.

6 **Job report and Complete job**

Answer the four report questions and press ✓ **Complete job** (section 6).



Clock running and before photo taken

REPORT

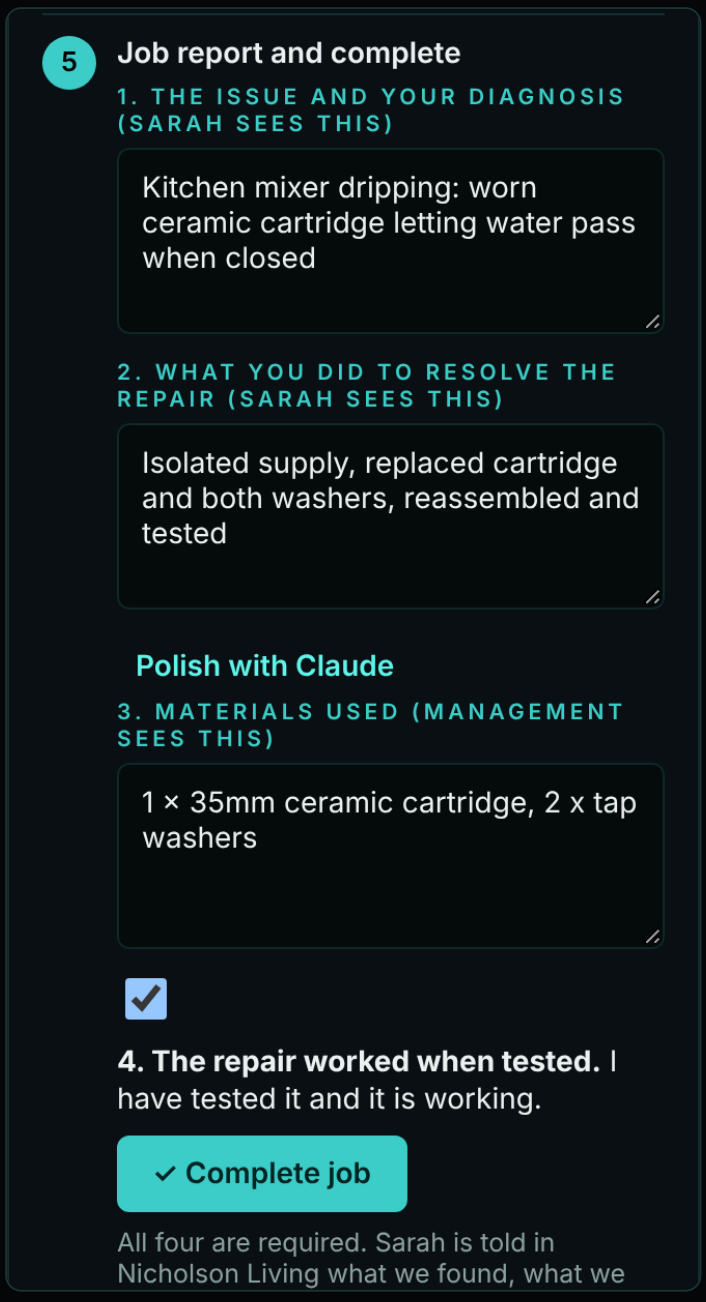
6 The job report

Four answers, all required. The first two and the tested confirmation are shown to the resident; materials stay internal.

QUESTION	WHAT TO WRITE	SEEN BY
1 · The issue and your diagnosis	What you found and why it happened. “Kitchen mixer dripping: worn ceramic cartridge letting water pass when closed.”	Resident, management
2 · What you did to resolve the repair	Exactly what you did. “Isolated supply, replaced cartridge and both washers, reassembled and tested.” Use **Polish with Claude**.	Resident, management
3 · Materials used	Every part and quantity, or “None”. “1 × 35mm ceramic cartridge, 2 × tap washers.”	Management only
4 · The repair worked when tested	Tick to confirm you tested it and it works.	Resident sees “Tested and working when we left”

BE SPECIFIC

“Fixed” is not a report. Write it so someone who has never seen the job understands what was wrong and what you did – because one day a council officer or a judge may read it.



The four-part report, ready to complete

NOT FINISHED

7 When you can’t finish on this visit

Delayed or not completed

Stop the clock, press **Couldn’t finish on this visit**, choose **Delayed** or **Not completed** and give the reason (part ordered, no access to a room, needs another trade). The office sees it straight away on the job and the tenancy record.

The return visit

Agree the next appointment in the app. When you go back, press **Start job** again: every visit has its own clock and its own before and after photos. The job completes on the visit where the work is finished.

Materials and expenses

Nothing is bought without Paul’s approval, whatever it costs. Request materials in **Work › Materials & orders** against the job; the PO number appears in My requests – quote it at the counter and photograph the receipt the same day. Expenses by 4pm Thursday with receipts.

Over 20 minutes?

A minor issue you spot that will take over 20 minutes: report it to the office so it is scheduled as its own job.

RESIDENT NOT IN

Record **No access (missed)** on the appointment, post a “Sorry we missed you” card and tell the office. Never force entry.

Something unsafe

Make it safe, tell Kevin straight away, and report it in **Safety › Accident & near miss** if anyone was hurt or nearly hurt. You may stop any work you believe is unsafe.

AFTER

8 What happens after you complete

1. **The resident is told**

   In Nicholson Living: what you found, what you did, that it was tested, your first name, the time on site, and your before and after photos. They are asked to rate the repair.

2. **Management is alerted**

   “Job to sign off” in NicoMGT. Management checks your photos side by side, the clock times against the appointment, the report and the materials.

3. **Signed off**

   Your card shows Signed off. The job counts for you on the Team league.

4. **Or sent back**

   Your card shows Sent back and the job returns to My jobs with what needs putting right; you get an alert. The resident is told it is back on our list. Put it right with a new visit.

5. **Resident says “not fixed”**

   The job reopens automatically and comes back to the list. The original completion stays on the register as rejected and is counted at appraisal. Right first time, every time.



What management sees: NicoMGT › Job sign-off, your before and after photos, clock times and report

SOP · N3-M

N3 The Nicholson Non-Negotiables

We are guests in our residents' homes. These standards apply to every job you attend, every time, whatever the job. They are how residents judge Nicholson — and they are not negotiable.

Would I accept this in my home?
Every job is finished to the standard of a competent tradesperson. If you wouldn't accept it at home, it isn't finished.

Fix it first time
Arrive with the materials you reasonably expect to need, and use every effort to finish on the first visit.

Leave it as you found it
The room and the area you worked in are left clean and tidy. Always.

Uniform, lanyard, ID
Worn and on show at all times. Residents must know who is in their home.

N3-M Every job, every time

BEFORE YOU SET OFF

- ☐ Read the job and bring the materials you reasonably believe you will need to complete it there and then.
- ☐ Office keys are signed out before you leave and signed back in when you return. Keys not signed out and back in carry a £50 charge.

AT THE DOOR

- ☐ Wear your work uniform and display your lanyard and ID badge at all times.
- ☐ Be courteous and respectful to every resident, every time.
- ☐ Offer to wear shoe covers before you step inside, and wear them if the resident would like you to.
- ☐ Appointment booked and nobody in: you must post a “Sorry we missed you” card before you leave.

ON THE JOB

- ☐ Log the time you arrive and the time you leave each property in NicoNet, so we have an accurate record of how long each job took.
- ☐ Take before and after photos of every job.
- ☐ Complete the work to the reasonable standard of a competent person — would I accept this in my home?
- ☐ Spot a minor issue while you’re there? Fix it there and then if it takes under 20 minutes. If it will take longer, report it to the office so it is scheduled.

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

- ☐ Leave the property and the area you worked in clean, tidy and as you found it.
- ☐ Remove all tools, materials, packaging and waste.

END OF THE DAY

- ☐ Update the office on the progress of your work in NicoNet before you finish.
- ☐ Sign back in any office keys.

N3-M Expenses and stock

EXPENSES

- ☐ Submit all expenses in NicoNet before 4pm each Thursday to be paid that week.
- ☐ Every expense has its receipt or invoice attached, unless management has agreed otherwise.

STOCK

- ☐ Stock is your responsibility. Tell the office when anything is running low — before it runs out — so materials are ordered in good time.

REPORT Report, don’t hide

IF YOU FIND	WHAT TO DO
Minor issue that takes over 20 minutes	Report it to the office so it is scheduled
Can’t finish on the first visit	Tell the office the same day: what’s needed and when you can return
Resident not in for the appointment	Post a “Sorry we missed you” card and tell the office
Stock running low	Tell the office before it runs out

STOCK

Expenses go in by 4pm Thursday with receipts attached. Stock levels are your responsibility.

Sign the N3

Open **NicoNet › SOP › Maintenance**, watch the film, read the standards and sign at the bottom. Your signature is recorded with the date and time on your staff file. You sign again whenever the N3 changes.

KIT What you carry, every job

- ☐ Uniform: polo, jumper, zip-up jacket
- ☐ Lanyard and ID badge
- ☐ Shoe covers
- ☐ “Sorry we missed you” cards
- ☐ Materials for the job
- ☐ Bin bags and cloths to leave it as you found it

REFERENCE

9 Warnings and quick answers

YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
Behind **on a job**	Past its target date	Finish it, or tell Kevin today what is stopping you
“This job is not allocated to you”	Someone else has it	Check with Kevin; never work a job that is not yours
“Take at least one before photo before you stop the clock”	No before photo yet	Take it, then stop the clock
“Stop the job clock first, then take the after photos”	The clock is still running	Stop the clock, then photograph
“Complete the job report…”	A report answer is missing	Answer all four and tick tested
“The last visit was recorded as delayed”	A new visit is needed	Press Start job for the return visit
Reply overdue	A resident message unanswered past 17:00	Reply now; Kevin has been emailed
Sent back	Management want it put right	Read the reason, agree a visit, redo it
Location not allowed	NicoNet cannot read your position	Settings › NicoNet › Location: While Using, Precise on. The job still starts.

No signal at the property?

Start the job as soon as you have signal; take photos with the app as soon as it reconnects. Tell the office in Messages if you could not start on time.

Phone died mid-job?

Tell Kevin straight away. The office can see where your visit got to and help close it properly. Never complete a job you have not finished.

SIGN-OFF

Acknowledgement

I confirm that I have read this Maintenance workflow guide in full, that I understand how my work reaches me in NicoNet, the steps I must follow and the standards I am held to, and that I will follow them on every job.

I understand that the app records the times I start and stop, my position when I do, my photos and my reports, and that this record is used to manage the work, to evidence it to residents, councils, ombudsmen and courts, and at my appraisal. I understand that a job I have not closed in the app is not complete, and that I will not be credited with it.

Name (block capitals) _____ Signature _____

Date _____ Line manager _____

Return the signed page to Kevin Sharp, or sign the N3 in NicoNet › SOP where the same acknowledgement is recorded on your file.